EXPLORASELF · LINK TO LEAD

# The Founder's Blueprint

## Scaling — twelve levels, four domains

There is a team, and the constraint is no longer the work. It is judgement, trust and where your attention goes.

A founder does not fail at one thing. They run out of clarity in one of four places: who they are, how they handle people, how the work actually runs, and what the market is telling them. This manual works all four, a level at a time, for twelve weeks.

**12 levels** | **4 domains every level** | **7 clarity points each** | **336 steps** | **48 worksheets**

SCALING

# The twelve levels

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| 01 | Two decisions given away | LEAD YOURSELF | FREE |
| 02 | Who could do your job | LEAD YOUR PEOPLE | FREE |
| 03 | A system with a new owner | LEAD YOUR BUSINESS | FREE |
| 04 | Find the next demand | LEAD THE MARKET | OPENS WITH ONE SESSION |
| 05 | The talk your team avoids | LEAD YOUR PEOPLE | OPENS WITH ONE SESSION |
| 06 | One number, read weekly | LEAD YOUR BUSINESS | PERSONAL LEADERSHIP LAB |
| 07 | Your bet, tested small | LEAD THE MARKET | PERSONAL LEADERSHIP LAB |
| 08 | Grow one leader | LEAD YOUR PEOPLE | PERSONAL LEADERSHIP LAB |
| 09 | Stop one thing | LEAD YOUR BUSINESS | PERSONAL LEADERSHIP LAB |
| 10 | Your edge, proven | LEAD THE MARKET | BUSINESS GROWTH HUB |
| 11 | What success is for | LEAD YOURSELF | BUSINESS GROWTH HUB |
| 12 | Held together, handed on | ALL FOUR | BUSINESS GROWTH HUB |

BEFORE THE FIRST LEVEL

# How to use this

Every level works all four domains and gives one of them the lead. Seven clarity points in each domain, so twenty-eight answers close a level. Twelve levels, twelve weeks.

The seven are the same every time, going a layer deeper at each level:

1. **Name it** — State the thing in one plain sentence, before any explaining.
2. **Evidence** — What is actually true here — something you can open, count or quote.
3. **Gap** — The distance between what you claimed and what the evidence shows.
4. **Cost** — What that gap is costing you now, in money, time or people.
5. **Decision** — The one choice in this that is yours to make this week.
6. **Move** — The smallest proportionate step, and the date it happens.
7. **Review** — What you will check to know it worked, and when.

**No step here can be answered by thinking hard.** Each one names what to open, what to count and what to write. If you find yourself reflecting rather than looking something up, you have skipped the instruction.

**Write in the book.** The lines are there because an answer in your head is not an answer. A level closes when all twenty-eight are written, not when you have read them.

**One level a week.** Faster is not better. The moves have to land in a real week before the next level asks you to look at what happened.

Where a level says a date, write a real one. Where it asks for a number, go and get the number. That is the whole method.

01

LEVEL 1 · SCALING · LEANS ON LEAD YOURSELF

# Two decisions given away

**THE PROMISE OF THIS LEVEL**

By Sunday you will have a written list of the decisions that should still reach you, two that should not, and both of those already given away in writing with the limits attached.

## Lead yourself

The decisions only you should still make — The short list, and everything that is not on it

1

**NAME IT**

List every decision that reached you last week.

2

**EVIDENCE**

Beside each, write who else could have made it, and what it would have cost if they had got it wrong.

3

GAP

Which decisions reached you that nobody needed you for?

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 3

## The short list, and everything off it

Decisions you personally made last week. Beside each, whether it genuinely required you — and if not, who it should have belonged to.

| DECISION | GENUINELY YOURS? Y/N | WHOSE IT SHOULD BE |
|---|---|---|
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |

DECISIONS WITH ANOTHER NAME BESIDE THEM

**Three kinds of decision.** Some decisions are irreversible and large — those stay yours for now. Some are reversible and small — those should never reach you. The middle group is where founders get stuck, because each one feels important in isolation. Sorting by reversibility rather than importance is what empties the middle.

What this decides. Two decisions that move to a named person this month.

4

COST

How many hours did those take, and what did they displace?

5

DECISION

Decide the two decisions you give away this week.

6

MOVE

Write who gets each, the limit on it, and when you tell them.

7 **REVIEW**

What will you check in a month — the quality of their calls, or how many still reach you?

## Lead your people

What they are allowed to decide — Authority stated, not implied

1 **NAME IT**

Name the three people closest to the work.

2 **EVIDENCE**

For each, write what they believe they are allowed to decide without you.

3 **GAP**

Ask one of them. Where is their answer narrower than yours?

4 **COST**

What has that gap cost — in delay, or in their confidence?

5 **DECISION**

Decide the explicit limit for each: amounts, situations, and what must come to you.

**WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 5**

### Authority stated, not implied

For each person reporting to you: what they may decide alone, what they decide and tell you, and what they bring to you first.

| WHO | DECIDES ALONE | DECIDES AND TELLS YOU | BRINGS TO YOU FIRST |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | |
| | | | |
| | | | |
| | | | |
| | | | |

**PEOPLE WHO KNOW WHAT THEY MAY DECIDE ALONE**

What this decides. Who you tell this week, and in what words.

6 **MOVE**

Write it, tell them, and note the date.

7 **REVIEW**

What will you see in two weeks if they believed you?

## Lead your business

Where decisions queue — The waiting is invisible from your side

1 **NAME IT**

Write where work currently waits for an approval.

2 EVIDENCE

Open the last month. Count the approvals and estimate the average wait.

3 GAP

Which approval has the longest wait and the lowest risk?

4 COST

What did the total waiting cost in delivery time?

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 4

## Where decisions queue

Decisions currently waiting on you, and how long the average one has waited.

DECISIONS WAITING ON YOU

AVERAGE DAYS WAITED

DECISION-DAYS CURRENTLY QUEUED

**A decision has a holding cost.** While a decision waits, the work behind it waits too — and that waiting is invisible from the desk of the person deciding. A fast adequate decision usually beats a slow excellent one, because the difference in quality is small and the difference in elapsed time is not. This is the clearest arithmetic at this stage and the least often done.

What this decides. Which category of decision you stop making, so the queue stops forming.

5 DECISION

Decide which approval is removed, delegated, or given a standing rule.

6 MOVE

Write the rule and the date it starts.

7 REVIEW

When do you measure the wait again, and what number is a pass?

## Lead the market

Decisions the customer feels — Speed is part of the product

1 NAME IT

Write the decisions that keep a customer waiting.

2 EVIDENCE

Find the last three. How long did each take from their question to your answer?

3 GAP

What were they doing while they waited?

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 3

### Speed the customer feels

The last five customer requests that needed a decision. Hours before the customer had an answer, on average, against what you would consider acceptable.

AVERAGE HOURS TO AN ANSWER

HOURS YOU WOULD CONSIDER ACCEPTABLE

HOURS BEYOND YOUR OWN STANDARD

What this decides. Who can answer this class of request without you, starting Monday.

4 COST

What does slowness cost at your price point — a lost deal, or a lower one?

5 **DECISION**

Decide the maximum response time you will hold, and who holds it.

6 **MOVE**

Write it, tell the team, and say where it is recorded.

7 **REVIEW**

How will you measure it, and when do you look?

This level closes when all twenty-eight are answered. Not before.

02

LEVEL 2 · SCALING · LEANS ON LEAD YOUR PEOPLE

# Who could do your job

THE PROMISE OF THIS LEVEL

By Sunday you will know who in your team could do your job badly today and well in a year, what the gap is for each, and one of them will have been told.

## Lead yourself

What you are training people into — They learn your habits, not your intentions

1

NAME IT

Write the habit you would least like your team to copy from you.

2

EVIDENCE

Find two places in the last month where somebody did exactly that.

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 2

### What you are training people into

Four habits of yours that your team has copied. Whether you intended each one.

| HABIT THEY COPIED | INTENDED? Y/N |
| --- | --- |
| | |
| | |
| | |
| | |

HABITS YOU CAN SEE REFLECTED

What this decides. One unintended habit you change in yourself, visibly.

3

GAP

Where did they learn it? Be honest about the source.

4 **COST**

What has it cost, now that more than one person does it?

5 **DECISION**

Decide what you change, visibly, so the copy changes.

6 **MOVE**

Write what you will do differently and the first occasion it shows.

7 **REVIEW**

What would tell you it spread? Name what you would look for.

## Lead your people

The bench you are building — Who could do more, and what is missing

1 **NAME IT**

Name everyone who could take a larger role within a year.

2 **EVIDENCE**

For each, write what they already do well and the one gap holding them back.

3 GAP

Which gap is the cheapest to close, and which is the most valuable?

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 3

## Who could do more

Everyone who could hold more than they currently do. What they would need, and whether anyone has told them you see it.

| WHO | WHAT THEY COULD HOLD | WHAT THEY WOULD NEED | TOLD? Y/N |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | |
| | | | |
| | | | |
| | | | |
| | | | |

PEOPLE YOU HAVE AN ANSWER ABOUT

What this decides. Who you tell this week, and what you offer them.

4 COST

What does an empty bench cost the day somebody leaves?

5 DECISION

Decide the one person and the one gap you work on this quarter.

6 MOVE

Write what they get: a task, a mentor, a decision, or a course — and the start date.

7 REVIEW

What will they be able to do by the end of the quarter that they cannot now?

## Lead your business

What a role actually requires — Written before it is needed

1

**NAME IT**

Write the role you would most struggle to replace tomorrow.

2

**EVIDENCE**

List what the person in it actually does in a week. Ask them if you are unsure.

3

**GAP**

Which parts are documented, and which exist only with them?

4

**COST**

What would a six-week vacancy cost in that role?

5

**DECISION**

Decide the one thing to document or cross-train first.

6 MOVE

Write who writes it or learns it, and by when.

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 6

### Written before it is needed

A role you will need within a year. Four boxes: the outcomes it owns, what it decides, who it works with, and what good looks like after six months.

| OUTCOMES IT OWNS | WHAT IT DECIDES |
|---|---|
| WHO IT WORKS WITH | GOOD, AFTER SIX MONTHS |

BOXES ANSWERED

What this decides. Whether somebody already here grows into it, or it is hired.

7 REVIEW

How do you test it — a day without them, or a dry run? Set the date.

## Lead the market

Who the customer trusts — Whether the relationship is with you or the business

1 NAME IT

Write how many of your top ten customers deal mainly with you personally.

2 EVIDENCE

Open the last three months. For each of the ten, who did they actually talk to?

3 GAP

Which relationships would be at risk if you stepped back?

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 3

## Whose relationship is it

Of your revenue, how much comes from customers whose main relationship is with you personally rather than with the business.

REVENUE TIED TO YOU PERSONALLY

TOTAL REVENUE

REVENUE THAT DEPENDS ON YOU BY NAME

**The difference between a practice and a business.** When customers buy the founder, the enterprise cannot be sold, cannot be left and cannot grow past one diary. Moving a relationship takes introductions made on purpose, a second person present before there is a problem, and the founder deliberately not being the one who answers. It is slow, and it is the single thing that changes what the business is.

What this decides. Which three relationships move to someone else, and by when.

4 COST

What is the annual value of the at-risk group?

5 DECISION

Decide the one relationship you will widen this quarter.

6 MOVE

Write who else enters it, how, and when the customer is introduced.

7 REVIEW

What will tell you the relationship transferred rather than thinned?

This level closes when all twenty-eight are answered. Not before.

03

LEVEL 3 · SCALING · LEANS ON LEAD YOUR BUSINESS

# A system with a new owner

THE PROMISE OF THIS LEVEL

By Sunday the system that matters most will be written, owned by somebody who is not you, and already run once under their name.

## Lead yourself

What you still rescue — The saves nobody asked you to make

1

NAME IT

Write the last three times you stepped in to fix something yourself.

2

EVIDENCE

For each, write whether anybody asked you to.

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 2

### The saves nobody asked for

Four times last month you stepped in to rescue something. What would have happened if you had not.

| WHAT YOU RESCUED | IF YOU HAD NOT |
| --- | --- |
| | |
| | |
| | |
| | |

RESCUES EXAMINED

What this decides. One rescue you will not make next time, and who you warn in advance.

3

GAP

What would have happened if you had not stepped in?

4 **COST**

What has rescuing cost — your hours, and their learning?

5 **DECISION**

Decide the next situation where you will deliberately not step in.

6 **MOVE**

Write what you will do instead, and who you tell beforehand.

7 **REVIEW**

What will you review afterwards, and with whom?

## Lead your people

Who owns the system — A process without an owner decays

1 **NAME IT**

List the systems the business depends on. Beside each, write the owner.

2 **EVIDENCE**

How many say your name, or nobody’s?

3 **GAP**

Which unowned system causes the most trouble?

4 **COST**

What has the lack of an owner cost in the last quarter?

5 DECISION

Decide the owner, and what owning it actually means.

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 5

### Who owns the system

Every system the business runs on. Its owner, and when that owner last changed anything in it.

| SYSTEM | OWNER | LAST IMPROVED |
|---|---|---|
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |

SYSTEMS WITH A NAMED OWNER _____

What this decides. Which ownerless system gets an owner, by name, this week.

6 MOVE

Write the handover: what they get, what they decide, what they report, and from when.

7 REVIEW

When is the first review with them, and what will you look at?

## Lead your business

The system that survives you — Documented, owned, and tested without you

1 NAME IT

Write the system whose failure would hurt most.

2

**EVIDENCE**

Open the last quarter. How often did it need you, and for what?

3

**GAP**

Which of those needs were genuine, and which were habit?

4

**COST**

What is the risk cost of it depending on one person?

5

**DECISION**

Decide what has to be written, measured, or decided elsewhere so it runs without you.

6

**MOVE**

Write the document, name the owner, and say where it lives.

7 REVIEW

Which week does it run entirely without you, and what do you check afterwards?

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 7

### Tested without you

The real test of a system is absence, not documentation. Design the test.

Between _____ , _____ runs _____ without me. I will not be asked unless _____ . Afterwards we review _____ .

THE DATES _____

WHO RUNS IT _____

THE SYSTEM _____

THE ONE GENUINE EXCEPTION _____

WHAT YOU REVIEW TOGETHER _____

THE ABSENCE TEST _____

What this decides. Put the dates in the calendar, and tell them today.

## Lead the market

What customers never see fail — The system behind the promise

1 NAME IT

Write the promise your delivery system has to keep every time.

2

EVIDENCE

Open the last twenty deliveries. Count how many kept it.

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 2

## What customers never see fail

Four things that must never fail from the customer’s side. What protects each, and what happens when that protection is absent.

| MUST NOT FAIL | WHAT PROTECTS IT | IF THE PROTECTION IS AWAY |
|---|---|---|
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |
| PROMISES WITH A PROTECTION | | |

What this decides. Which name in the middle column becomes a system this quarter.

3

GAP

What was different about the ones that did not?

4

COST

What does one public failure cost at your size now?

5

DECISION

Decide the safeguard that catches it before the customer does.

6

MOVE

Write the safeguard, its owner, and the date.

7

REVIEW

When do you count the next twenty, and what rate is acceptable?

This level closes when all twenty-eight are answered. Not before.

04

LEVEL 4 · SCALING · LEANS ON LEAD THE MARKET

# Find the next demand

**THE PROMISE OF THIS LEVEL**

By Sunday you will have one evidenced answer to where the next demand is, drawn from your own data and two conversations — and one small, dated test of it already booked.

## Lead yourself

Where you are looking — Attention is a strategic act

1 **NAME IT**

Write where your attention has gone in the last month. Inside the business, or outside it?

2 **EVIDENCE**

Count the hours spent on anything beyond the next ninety days.

3 **GAP**

What does that number say about who is thinking about the future here?

**WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 3**

### Attention is a strategic act

Where your attention actually went last month. Five areas, with roughly what share of your thinking each took.

| AREA | SHARE OF ATTENTION % |
|---|---|
| | |
| | |
| | |
| | |
| | |

**ACCOUNTED FOR** _____

What this decides. Which area gets attention next month that got none last month.

4 **COST**

What has it cost to have nobody looking up?

5 **DECISION**

Decide the recurring block that belongs to looking outward.

6 **MOVE**

Put it in the calendar for the quarter and write what happens in it.

7 **REVIEW**

What will you have at the end of the quarter that proves it was used?

## Lead your people

Who hears the market first — The signal arrives at the edges

1 **NAME IT**

Name the people in your business who speak to customers or suppliers most.

2

EVIDENCE

Ask each what they have heard changing. Write their answers verbatim.

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 2

### Who hears the market first

The people at the edges — support, delivery, sales. What each has heard more than once lately, and whether it ever reached you.

| WHO | WHAT THEY KEEP HEARING | REACHED YOU BEFORE? Y/N |
|---|---|---|
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |

SIGNALS COLLECTED FROM THE EDGES

What this decides. What route carries this to you every month without a worksheet.

3

GAP

What did more than one of them mention?

4

COST

What has it cost that this was never collected?

5

DECISION

Decide how this gets collected from now on, and how often.

6

MOVE

Write the mechanism, the owner, and the first date.

7 REVIEW

What would make you act on it? Name the threshold.

## Lead your business

What you could deliver that you do not — Capability already in the building

1 NAME IT

Write what your team can already do that you do not currently sell.

2 EVIDENCE

Open the last six months. Where did you do it anyway, unpriced, as a favour?

3 GAP

How many times, and for whom?

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 3

### Capability already in the building

Four things you could deliver tomorrow with what already exists here, and have not. What stopped each.

| WHAT YOU COULD DELIVER | WHAT STOPPED IT |
| --- | --- |
| | |
| | |
| | |
| | |

UNUSED CAPABILITY, WITH ITS REASON

What this decides. One capability you take to market this quarter.

4 COST

What was that worth at a fair price?

5 **DECISION**

Decide whether it becomes an offer, a paid extra, or stops.

6 **MOVE**

Write the decision, the price, and the first customer you offer it to.

7 **REVIEW**

How many offers until you judge it, and by what date?

## Lead the market

Where the next demand is — Evidence, not instinct

1 **NAME IT**

Write where you believe demand is moving.

2 EVIDENCE

Open your enquiries from the last six months. What are people asking for that you did not offer a year ago?

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 2

## Evidence, not instinct

Four pieces of evidence that demand is moving. Where each came from, and how strong it is.

| EVIDENCE | SOURCE | HOW STRONG |
|---|---|---|
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |

SIGNALS WITH A SOURCE

**Why a source matters more than a conclusion.** At this size your conclusions become other people's instructions. A conclusion carries no way for anyone to check it, so it cannot be corrected and cannot be improved — it can only be obeyed or quietly ignored. Stating the source lets someone bring you better evidence, which is the only way a leader at this stage stays accurate.

What this decides. Which signal you test, and what would prove you wrong.

3 GAP

Which request appears most, and is it growing?

4 COST

What is that group worth if you served it properly?

5 DECISION

Decide the smallest test that would tell you whether it is real.

6 MOVE

Write the test, what it costs, and the date it runs.

7

REVIEW

What result would justify building for it, and what result would close the question?

This level closes when all twenty-eight are answered. Not before.

05

LEVEL 5 · SCALING · LEANS ON LEAD YOUR PEOPLE

# The talk your team avoids

**THE PROMISE OF THIS LEVEL**

By Sunday the conversation your team cannot have will have been had — opened by you, with the real subject named in the first minute, and a written record of what was decided.

## Lead yourself

What you are not saying — The thing everybody knows and nobody names

1

**NAME IT**

Write the thing in your business that everybody knows and nobody says aloud.

**WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 1**

### The thing nobody names

Everybody knows. Nobody says it. Write it once, plainly, where only you can see it.

The thing we are all avoiding is _____. I have not said it because _____. Saying it would mean _____.

**THE THING**

**WHY YOU HAVE NOT**

**WHAT IT WOULD MEAN**

**NAMED, AT LEAST HERE**

What this decides. Whether you open it, and in which room.

2

**EVIDENCE**

How long has it been true? Write the months.

3

**GAP**

What is your reason for not naming it?

4 **COST**

What has the silence cost — in trust, in people leaving, or in work avoided?

5 **DECISION**

Decide whether you name it, and in what setting.

6 **MOVE**

Write the first sentence you would use, and the date.

7 **REVIEW**

What will be different afterwards if it went well?

## Lead your people

The conversation your team cannot have — They need you to open it

1 **NAME IT**

Write the conversation your team needs but cannot start themselves.

2 **EVIDENCE**

Who is affected, and what has each of them done instead of raising it?

3 **GAP**

Why can they not open it — position, fear, or no forum?

4 **COST**

What is it costing in the work right now?

5 DECISION

Decide the forum, the people, and the single question that opens it.

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 5

### Opening it safely

Four boxes before you raise it: what you will say first, what you will not do with what you hear, who speaks before you, and what happens afterwards.

| WHAT YOU SAY FIRST | WHAT YOU WILL NOT DO WITH IT |
| --- | --- |
| WHO SPEAKS BEFORE YOU | WHAT HAPPENS AFTERWARDS |

BOXES ANSWERED

What this decides. The date, and who you tell beforehand.

6 MOVE

Write the question, who is in the room, and the date.

7 REVIEW

What is recorded afterwards, by whom, and who sees it?

## Lead your business

What the silence is doing to the work — Unspoken problems become operational ones

1 NAME IT

Write where work is currently slowed or duplicated because of the unsaid thing.

2 **EVIDENCE**

Find two recent examples with dates.

3 **GAP**

What do people do to work around it?

4 **COST**

What has the workaround cost in hours this quarter?

**WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 4**

### What the silence costs the work

The unspoken thing has an operational shadow. How many people work around it, and hours a month each loses to the workaround.

**PEOPLE WORKING AROUND IT** _____

**HOURS A MONTH EACH** _____

**HOURS A MONTH SPENT WORKING AROUND IT** _____

What this decides. Whether the conversation is now cheaper than the workaround.

5 **DECISION**

Decide the interim arrangement until the conversation changes things.

6 **MOVE**

Write it, tell the people affected, and note the date.

7 **REVIEW**

When does the arrangement end or become permanent?

## Lead the market

Whether the customer can tell — Internal strain shows up outside eventually

1 **NAME IT**

Write whether this has reached customers. Be honest.

2 **EVIDENCE**

Open complaints, delays and cancellations this quarter. How many trace back to it?

3 **GAP**

Which customers encountered it more than once?

**WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 3**

### Whether the customer can tell

Three ways internal strain could be visible from outside. What a customer would notice, and whether any has.

| HOW IT COULD SHOW | WHAT THEY WOULD NOTICE | HAS ANYONE? Y/N |
|---|---|---|
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |

**WAYS IT COULD REACH OUTSIDE**

What this decides. Which outward symptom you protect while you fix the inward cause.

4 **COST**

What is that group worth, and how exposed is it?

5 **DECISION**

Decide what, if anything, is said to them.

6 **MOVE**

Write what you would say and when, or write plainly that you have chosen not to, and why.

7 **REVIEW**

What will you watch in those accounts over the next quarter?

This level closes when all twenty-eight are answered. Not before.

06

LEVEL 6 · SCALING · LEANS ON LEAD YOUR BUSINESS

# One number, read weekly

THE PROMISE OF THIS LEVEL

By Sunday the business will have one number that cannot be argued with, read weekly by a named person, with the last eight weeks already plotted and the trend written down.

## Lead yourself

The number you avoid — The one you do not look at often

1

NAME IT

Write the number in your business you check least often.

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 1

### The number you avoid

There is one you do not look at often. Name it and say why.

I avoid looking at _____ because _____. The last time I checked it was _____, and it was _____.

THE NUMBER _____

WHY YOU AVOID IT _____

WHEN YOU LAST CHECKED _____

WHAT IT WAS _____

THE AVOIDED NUMBER _____

What this decides. Who else sees it from now on, so avoiding it stops being available.

2

EVIDENCE

Find its last four readings. Write them.

3 **GAP**

Why do you avoid it — it is hard to get, or hard to see?

4 **COST**

What has not watching it cost?

5 **DECISION**

Decide whether it matters. If it does, it gets read weekly. If not, say so and stop pretending.

6 **MOVE**

Write the decision, and if it stays, who reads it and when.

7 **REVIEW**

What reading would make you act, and what would you do?

## Lead your people

Who owns a number — Every person with one real figure

1 **NAME IT**

List your team. Beside each, write the number they own.

2 **EVIDENCE**

How many names have no number, or share one?

3 **GAP**

Which person would most benefit from owning a figure of their own?

4 COST

What does it cost when nobody owns the outcome?

5 DECISION

Decide the number each of them owns. One each, meaningful, within their control.

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 5

### Every person with one real figure

One number each person owns — one they can actually move, not one they are merely measured by.

| WHO | THEIR NUMBER | CAN THEY ACTUALLY MOVE IT? Y/N |
|---|---|---|
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |

PEOPLE WITH A NUMBER _____

What this decides. Which number changes hands, because the wrong person is holding it.

6 MOVE

Write the list, tell them, and say where the numbers are recorded.

7 REVIEW

When is the first weekly read, and what happens when one is off?

## Lead your business

The number that tells the truth — One figure, weekly, that cannot be argued with

1 NAME IT

Write the single number that most honestly reflects whether the business is working.

2

**EVIDENCE**

Find it for each of the last eight weeks. Write the eight figures.

3

**GAP**

What does the trend say that your impression did not?

4

**COST**

What has reading it late or not at all cost this year?

5

**DECISION**

Decide the target, with a date, and the reading that triggers action.

6 MOVE

Write where the number comes from, who updates it, and which day it is read.

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 6

### One figure, weekly

Not a dashboard. One figure, checked on a named day, with a stated consequence.

Every _____ , _____ reports _____ . It is _____ now. If it goes below _____ , _____ .

THE DAY _____

WHO REPORTS IT _____

THE FIGURE _____

WHERE IT IS NOW _____

THE LINE _____

WHAT HAPPENS _____

THE WEEKLY NUMBER _____

**Why one, and why it must be reportable by somebody else.** A dashboard tells you everything and decides nothing, and software will assemble one this afternoon. One figure, named day, stated consequence, reported by a person who is not you — that changes behaviour, because it can be missed and missing it means something. Choose the figure closest to the work rather than the one easiest to collect.

What this decides. Whether you would actually do what the last blank says.

7 REVIEW

When is the first review, and who is in it?

## Lead the market

The number the customer creates — The outside measure, not the inside one

1 NAME IT

Write the number that reflects what customers actually do, not what you produce.

2 **EVIDENCE**

Find it for the last three months. Repeat purchase, referral, retention — whichever applies.

3 **GAP**

What direction is it moving, and since when?

**WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 3**

### The number the customer creates

An outside measure rather than an inside one. Customers at the start of the last twelve months, and how many are still with you.

**STILL WITH YOU** _____

**CUSTOMERS TWELVE MONTHS AGO** _____

**CUSTOMERS WHO STAYED A YEAR** _____

**Inside numbers and outside numbers.** Revenue, utilisation and pipeline are produced by you and can be made to look better without anything improving. Retention is produced by customers and cannot. At this stage, when there are enough internal figures to tell any story, it is worth keeping at least one measure you do not control.

What this decides. Which departing customer you call, and what you ask.

4 **COST**

What is a point of movement worth in revenue?

5 **DECISION**

Decide the one action aimed at it this quarter.

6 **MOVE**

Write the action, the owner, and the date.

7

REVIEW

When do you read it again, and what change counts as proof?

This level closes when all twenty-eight are answered. Not before.

07

LEVEL 7 · SCALING · LEANS ON LEAD THE MARKET

# Your bet, tested small

THE PROMISE OF THIS LEVEL

By Sunday the bet you are making will be written down as a bet — what you are assuming, what it costs if you are wrong, and the smallest test that would tell you — and the test will be booked.

## Lead yourself

What you are assuming — Every plan rests on something unproven

1

NAME IT

Write the biggest thing you are currently betting the business on.

2

EVIDENCE

List what has to be true for it to work. Three to five items.

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 2

### What you are assuming

Every plan rests on something unproven. Four assumptions underneath yours, and what would show each to be wrong.

| ASSUMPTION | WHAT WOULD SHOW IT IS WRONG |
|---|---|
| | |
| | |
| | |
| | |

ASSUMPTIONS THAT COULD BE DISPROVED

What this decides. Which assumption you test first, because it is cheapest to be wrong about now.

3

GAP

Which of those have you tested, and which are you taking on faith? Mark each.

4 **COST**

What does the business lose if the untested one is wrong?

5 **DECISION**

Decide the smallest thing that would test it.

6 **MOVE**

Write the test, what it costs, and the date it runs.

7 **REVIEW**

What result would make you continue, and what result would stop you?

## Lead your people

Who else is betting — Your bet is their job

1 **NAME IT**

Write who in your business is affected if this bet does not work.

2 **EVIDENCE**

What have you told them about it? Find the actual message or meeting.

3 **GAP**

What do they believe the plan is, compared with what it is?

4 COST

What does it cost when people learn late that a direction changed?

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 4

### Your bet is their job

Who carries risk if this bet fails. What they stand to lose, and whether they know the bet is being made.

| WHO | WHAT THEY STAND TO LOSE | KNOWS? Y/N |
|---|---|---|
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |

PEOPLE WHOSE EXPOSURE YOU HAVE CONSIDERED

What this decides. Who you tell, what you tell them, and when.

5 DECISION

Decide what you tell them, and how much uncertainty you share.

6 MOVE

Write what you will say and when.

7 REVIEW

What will you see afterwards that tells you they understood?

## Lead your business

What the bet asks of operations — A new direction lands on existing capacity

1 NAME IT

Write what the business would have to do differently if the bet pays off.

2 EVIDENCE

Open current capacity. What is at or near its limit already?

3 GAP

Which part breaks first under the new direction?

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 3

## What the bet asks of operations

A new direction lands on existing capacity. Four things that would have to change, and who absorbs each.

| WHAT MUST CHANGE | WHO ABSORBS IT | INSTEAD OF WHAT |
|---|---|---|
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |

CHANGES WITH SOMETHING NAMED IN EXCHANGE

**Capacity is conserved.** A business has a fixed amount of attention at any moment, and a new direction does not create more of it. Whatever the plan requires is taken from something, and if nobody names what, it is taken from quality, from recovery or from the people least able to refuse. Naming the exchange in advance is not pessimism; it is the difference between a decision and an announcement.

What this decides. What stops, so the bet has somewhere to live.

4 COST

What would that break cost at the moment of most demand?

5 DECISION

Decide the one thing prepared in advance.

6 MOVE

Write it, the owner, and the date.

7 **REVIEW**

How will you know it is ready, and who signs it off?

## Lead the market

The bet you are making — Stated plainly, with a date

1 **NAME IT**

Write the bet as a sentence: “We believe that, by [date], [this] will be true.”

2 **EVIDENCE**

Find the evidence you already have for it. Numbers, conversations, enquiries.

3 **GAP**

What evidence is missing that would make it convincing to somebody else?

4 **COST**

What is the cost of being wrong, and the gain of being right?

5

DECISION

Decide the review date, before the full commitment.

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 5

### The bet, stated plainly

One sentence, with a date and a condition for being wrong. Written down so it cannot be quietly rewritten later.

We are betting that _____. We will know by _____. We will have been wrong if _____, and then we will _____.

THE BET

THE DATE

WHAT WOULD MEAN YOU WERE WRONG

WHAT YOU WOULD DO

THE BET, WITH ITS DATE

What this decides. Who holds you to the date.

6

MOVE

Write the date, and what you will look at on it.

7

REVIEW

Who holds you to that date?

This level closes when all twenty-eight are answered. Not before.

08

LEVEL 8 · SCALING · LEANS ON LEAD YOUR PEOPLE

# Grow one leader

THE PROMISE OF THIS LEVEL

By Sunday one person will know they are being grown, what they are being grown into, and what they must demonstrate — in writing, agreed by both of you.

## Lead yourself

What you model when it is hard — They learn leadership from your worst week, not your best

1

NAME IT

Write what you did the last time something went badly wrong.

2

EVIDENCE

Who saw it? Name them.

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 2

### What you model when it is hard

Three difficult moments in the last quarter. What you did, and what somebody watching would have learned from it.

| THE MOMENT | WHAT YOU DID | WHAT THEY LEARNED |
|---|---|---|
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |

LESSONS YOU TAUGHT WITHOUT MEANING TO

What this decides. What you would want them to learn, and what has to change for that.

3

GAP

What did that teach them about how to behave under pressure here?

4 **COST**

What has it cost, if it is now copied?

5 **DECISION**

Decide what you want the next hard week to look like.

6 **MOVE**

Write the two behaviours you will hold, and the person who may call you on it.

7 **REVIEW**

When will you ask them whether you held it?

## Lead your people

Who is becoming a leader — Named, told, and given something real

1 **NAME IT**

Name the person most likely to lead others here within a year.

2 **EVIDENCE**

Write what they have actually led so far, and how it went.

3 **GAP**

What is the gap between that and leading a function?

4 **COST**

What does it cost if they are never told they are being considered?

5 **DECISION**

Decide what they are given this quarter: a project, a person, or a decision.

**WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 5**

### Named, told, and given something real

Who is becoming a leader here. What real thing they will own next, and when you tell them.

| WHO | WHAT THEY WILL OWN | WHEN YOU TELL THEM |
|---|---|---|
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |

**PEOPLE WITH A DATE** _____

What this decides. Nothing further. Put the three conversations in the calendar.

6 **MOVE**

Write what, with what support, and the date you tell them.

7 **REVIEW**

What must they demonstrate by the end of the quarter?

## Lead your business

What leading here means — Defined, so it can be learned

1 **NAME IT**

Write what a leader in this business is actually responsible for.

2 **EVIDENCE**

Open the last quarter. What did your best people do that you would call leading?

3 **GAP**

Which of those behaviours is written down anywhere?

4 **COST**

What does an undefined standard cost when you promote somebody?

5 **DECISION**

Decide the three things leading here means.

6 **MOVE**

Write them, and where they live.

**WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 6**

## What leading here means

Four boxes so it can be learned rather than guessed: what a leader here decides, protects, is accountable for, and is never allowed to do.

| DECIDES | PROTECTS |
| --- | --- |
| **ACCOUNTABLE FOR** | **NEVER DOES** |

**BOXES ANSWERED** _____

What this decides. Who reads this and tells you what they would have guessed wrong.

7 **REVIEW**

Who is the first to be measured against them, and when?

## Lead the market

Who represents the business — Leadership is visible outside too

1

**NAME IT**

Write who other than you a customer would accept as the business.

2

**EVIDENCE**

Open the last quarter. Where did somebody other than you speak for it?

3

**GAP**

What happened, and what did the customer do next?

**WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 3**

### Who represents the business

Every outward-facing situation — pitches, events, difficult calls. Who does it now, and who else could within six months.

| SITUATION | WHO DOES IT NOW | WHO ELSE COULD |
|---|---|---|
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |

**SITUATIONS WITH A SECOND NAME** _____

What this decides. Which outward situation somebody else takes next, with you in the room.

4

**COST**

What is the risk cost of one voice only?

5

**DECISION**

Decide the next occasion somebody else represents the business.

6 **MOVE**

Write the occasion, the person, and what they are briefed on.

7 **REVIEW**

What will you ask the customer afterwards?

This level closes when all twenty-eight are answered. Not before.

09

LEVEL 9 · SCALING · LEANS ON LEAD YOUR BUSINESS

# Stop one thing

THE PROMISE OF THIS LEVEL

By Sunday something will have been stopped. Not deprioritised — stopped, with the people affected told, and the hours it frees already committed elsewhere.

## Lead yourself

What you cannot stop doing — The work you protect for your own reasons

1

NAME IT

Write the thing you keep doing that somebody else should own by now.

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 1

### What you protect for your own reasons

There is work you keep that the business does not need you to keep. Say why you keep it.

I keep doing _____ because _____. The business would be fine if _____ did it. What I would lose is _____.

THE WORK _____

YOUR REASON _____

WHO COULD DO IT _____

WHAT YOU WOULD LOSE _____

WHY IT IS STILL YOURS _____

What this decides. Keep it on purpose, or let it go — and say which out loud.

2

EVIDENCE

Count the hours it took last month.

3 **GAP**

What do you get from it that you would miss — competence, contact, or control?

4 **COST**

What has holding it cost the work only you can do?

5 **DECISION**

Decide whether it goes, and to whom.

6 **MOVE**

Write the handover and the date, or write plainly that you are keeping it and why.

7 **REVIEW**

When do you revisit this decision?

## Lead your people

What they are doing that should stop — Everybody has one

1 **NAME IT**

Ask each of your team: what do you do every week that you think is pointless? Write the answers.

2 **EVIDENCE**

How many named the same thing?

3 **GAP**

Which of those did you introduce?

**WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 3**

## What they should stop

Everybody has one. For each person, the thing they do that no longer earns its place, and what they do instead.

| WHO | WHAT THEY STOP | WHAT INSTEAD |
|---|---|---|
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |

**STOPS WITH A REPLACEMENT** _____

What this decides. Which conversation you have first.

4 **COST**

What is the total weekly cost of the most-named item?

5 **DECISION**

Decide what stops, and what replaces it if anything.

6 **MOVE**

Write the decision, tell them, and note the date.

7 **REVIEW**

When will you ask again, and what would a healthy answer sound like?

## Lead your business

What you will stop doing — Stopped, not deprioritised

1

**NAME IT**

List everything the business currently does. Services, processes, reports, meetings.

2

**EVIDENCE**

Beside each, write what it costs weekly and what would happen if it stopped.

3

**GAP**

Which one costs most and would be least missed?

4

**COST**

What could those hours produce instead? Be specific.

5

**DECISION**

Decide what stops. One thing, fully, not partially.

6 MOVE

Write the stop date, who is told, and what happens to anything in flight.

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 6

### Stopped, not deprioritised

Four things the business stops. The date each actually ends, who is told, and what is freed.

| WHAT STOPS | ENDS ON | WHO IS TOLD | WHAT IT FREES |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | |
| | | | |
| | | | |
| | | | |

STOPS WITH A REAL DATE

**Why stopping is harder than starting.** Starting is visible, flattering and easy to approve. Stopping requires admitting something was worth doing once and is not now, and it usually touches someone who has been doing it well. That is why portfolios of initiatives grow and almost never shrink — and why one real stop with a date does more for capacity than three new priorities.

What this decides. Which stop you announce this week, with its date.

7 REVIEW

When do you check the hours actually went where you intended?

## Lead the market

The customers you stop serving — The hardest stop, and often the right one

1 NAME IT

Write the group of customers who take most and return least.

2 EVIDENCE

Count them, the hours they took last quarter, and what they paid.

3 **GAP**

What is the effective rate, and how does it compare with your best group?

4 **COST**

What could those hours have earned at the better rate?

**WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 4**

## The customers you stop serving

The segment you would stop. What it brings in a year, and the hours a year it consumes across everyone.

**ANNUAL REVENUE FROM THEM**

**HOURS A YEAR ACROSS EVERYONE**

**WHAT THIS SEGMENT PAYS AN HOUR**

What this decides. Stop, reprice, or reshape — with a date and who tells them.

5 **DECISION**

Decide: raise the price, change the terms, or stop serving them.

6 **MOVE**

Write what you will say, to whom, and when. Keep it respectful and plain.

7 **REVIEW**

What date do you review the outcome, and what would tell you it was right?

This level closes when all twenty-eight are answered. Not before.

10

LEVEL 10 · SCALING · LEANS ON LEAD THE MARKET

# Your edge, proven

THE PROMISE OF THIS LEVEL

By Sunday you will have one advantage you can state, evidence from three customers that it is real, and the first place it has been made visible.

## Lead yourself

What you are actually good at — Yours, not the business's

1

NAME IT

Write what you personally do better than most people in your field.

2

EVIDENCE

Find three pieces of evidence from the last year. Outcomes, not compliments.

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 2

### Yours, not the business's

Three things you are genuinely good at — yours personally. Evidence for each from outside your own judgement.

| WHAT YOU ARE GOOD AT | EVIDENCE FROM OUTSIDE |
| --- | --- |
| | |
| | |
| | |

STRENGTHS WITH OUTSIDE EVIDENCE

What this decides. Which one the next year is arranged around.

3

GAP

How much of your week currently uses it?

4 **COST**

What has it cost to spend your week elsewhere?

5 **DECISION**

Decide how much of your time goes to it next quarter.

6 **MOVE**

Write the hours and where they come from.

7 **REVIEW**

What will exist at the end of the quarter that proves it?

## Lead your people

What the team is uniquely good at — Capability that took years and could be lost

1 **NAME IT**

Write what your team can do that would be hard for a competitor to assemble.

2 **EVIDENCE**

Who holds that capability? Name them.

3 GAP

What would it take to rebuild it if those people left?

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 3

## Capability that took years

Four things this team is uniquely good at. How long each took to build, and what would happen if the person holding it left.

| CAPABILITY | YEARS TO BUILD | IF THEY LEFT |
|---|---|---|
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |

YEARS OF CAPABILITY IN THE BUILDING _____

**Capability is not the same as headcount.** Skills can be hired. Judgement built on hundreds of specific cases cannot, and it leaves in a single afternoon with no handover. Counting the years makes visible what no org chart shows — and it is the clearest argument for writing things down while the person who knows them is still here.

What this decides. Which capability gets a second holder this quarter.

4 COST

What is the risk cost of that concentration?

5 DECISION

Decide how it is protected: documented, taught, or rewarded.

6 MOVE

Write what you will do and by when.

7 REVIEW

How will you know it is safer in six months?

## Lead your business

What you do that cannot be copied quickly — Advantage built into the operation

1 NAME IT

Write the part of how you work that a competitor could not reproduce in a month.

2 EVIDENCE

Find the evidence: speed, consistency, cost, or quality. Write the numbers.

3 GAP

How long did it take you to build?

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 3

### What cannot be copied quickly

Four things in how you operate that a competitor could not replicate in six months. Why not, honestly.

| WHAT YOU DO | WHY IT IS HARD TO COPY |
| --- | --- |
| | |
| | |
| | |
| | |

ADVANTAGES WITH A REASON

What this decides. Which advantage you deliberately deepen, rather than assume.

4 COST

What would losing it cost in price or in win rate?

5 **DECISION**

Decide the one thing that deepens it this quarter.

6 **MOVE**

Write the action, the owner, and the date.

7 **REVIEW**

What measure shows it deepened?

## Lead the market

The edge that is actually yours — Stated, evidenced, and visible

1 **NAME IT**

Write the advantage you believe you have.

2 **EVIDENCE**

Ask three customers what they think you do better than the alternatives. Paste their answers.

3 **GAP**

Which part of your belief did none of them mention?

4 **COST**

What has claiming an unfelt advantage cost — in price, or in trust?

5 DECISION

Decide the version you can state and evidence.

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 5

## Stated, evidenced, visible

The edge in one sentence, with the evidence attached and a place it is actually visible to customers.

Our edge is _____. The evidence is _____. A customer meets it at _____.

THE EDGE

THE EVIDENCE

WHERE A CUSTOMER MEETS IT

THE EDGE, STATED

What this decides. Where it becomes visible this quarter.

6 MOVE

Write it, where it appears, and the date it goes live.

7 REVIEW

How many enquiries until you can judge it, and what will you compare?

This level closes when all twenty-eight are answered. Not before.

11

LEVEL 11 · SCALING · LEANS ON LEAD YOURSELF

# What success is for

THE PROMISE OF THIS LEVEL

By Sunday you will have written what this business is supposed to make possible in your life, checked it against your last three months honestly, and changed one thing that was pulling the other way.

## Lead yourself

What success should make possible — The question the business cannot answer for you

1

NAME IT

Write what you want this business to make possible, outside the business.

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 1

### The question the business cannot answer

Imagine the business reaches the number. Picture the Tuesday afterwards, not the celebration.

If this works, I want more room for _____ and to be present for _____. I would finally give attention to _____.

WHAT YOU WANT ROOM FOR

WHO YOU WANT TO BE PRESENT FOR

WHAT YOU WOULD ATTEND TO

WHAT SUCCESS IS FOR

What this decides. One thing from this answer that starts before the number arrives.

2

EVIDENCE

Open the last three months. How much of that has actually been possible? Give examples or say none.

3 **GAP**

What has been traded for the growth, specifically?

4 **COST**

What will another year at this pace cost that thing?

5 **DECISION**

Decide the one change that moves it, even slightly.

6 **MOVE**

Write what you will change, and the first week it applies.

7 **REVIEW**

What date do you review it, and who will notice if nothing changed?

## Lead your people

Who else is paying for it — The cost rarely stops at you

1 **NAME IT**

Write who else has carried the cost of this growth. At work or at home.

2 **EVIDENCE**

What have they actually said about it? Find the last time.

3 **GAP**

What did you do with what they said?

4 COST

What has it cost that relationship?

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 4

### Who else is paying for it

The cost of this plan rarely stops at you. Who else carries it, what it costs them, and whether it was ever discussed.

| WHO | WHAT IT COSTS THEM | DISCUSSED? Y/N |
|---|---|---|
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |

COSTS CARRIED BY OTHER PEOPLE

What this decides. Which conversation you have, and when.

5 DECISION

Decide what you will change, or what you will say.

6 MOVE

Write it, and the day.

7 REVIEW

What will tell you it landed?

## Lead your business

Whether the business can hold it — Your life change has operational consequences

1 NAME IT

Write what would have to be true at work for that change to be possible.

2

EVIDENCE

Open the week. What currently depends on you in a way that prevents it?

3

GAP

Which of those could be handed over within a quarter?

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 3

## Can the business hold it

The life you described has operational consequences. Four of them, and what each requires of the business.

| WHAT YOU WANT | WHAT THE BUSINESS MUST BE ABLE TO DO |
| --- | --- |
| | |
| | |
| | |
| | |

WANTS WITH AN OPERATIONAL REQUIREMENT

What this decides. Which requirement the next quarter builds.

4

COST

What does it cost to keep them?

5

DECISION

Decide the one that moves first.

6

MOVE

Write who takes it, from when, with what support.

7 **REVIEW**

When do you test it, with a real absence, and for how long?

## Lead the market

What the business is for now — The purpose, at this size

1 **NAME IT**

Write what this business is for, now that it is this size.

2 **EVIDENCE**

Compare it with what you wrote when you started. Find the earlier version if you can.

3 **GAP**

What changed, and was it chosen or drifted into?

4 **COST**

What does serving a purpose you did not choose cost over a year?

5

DECISION

Decide the version you will hold for the next year.

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 5

### What the business is for now

The purpose, at this size. It is allowed to have changed since the beginning — most do.

At this size, this business exists so that _____ can _____. That is different from when we started, because _____.

WHO

WHAT BECOMES POSSIBLE

WHAT CHANGED

THE PURPOSE, RESTATED

What this decides. Who hears this version first.

6

MOVE

Write it, and who you will say it to first.

7

REVIEW

What date do you check whether the business is actually serving it?

This level closes when all twenty-eight are answered. Not before.

12

LEVEL 12 · SCALING · LEANS ON ALL FOUR

# Held together, handed on

THE PROMISE OF THIS LEVEL

By Sunday the business will hold together on one page — the decisions, the people, the systems, the numbers and the purpose — and somebody other than you will have read it and told you what is still only in your head.

## Lead yourself

What has changed in you — Twelve levels, honestly reviewed

1

NAME IT

Read back your answers across all eleven levels. Write the thing that appeared most often.

2

EVIDENCE

Count the levels it appeared in and name them.

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 2

### Twelve levels, honestly reviewed

Three things that changed in how you lead. The evidence for each — something somebody else would have noticed.

| WHAT CHANGED | WHAT SOMEBODY ELSE NOTICED |
| --- | --- |
| | |
| | |
| | |

CHANGES WITH OUTSIDE EVIDENCE

What this decides. What carries forward, and what you deliberately stop.

3

GAP

What have you actually changed about it, and what did you only decide to change?

4 **COST**

What does another year of it cost at this size?

5 **DECISION**

Decide the one thing you hold for the coming year, not the quarter.

6 **MOVE**

Write it as something observable, and the monthly moment you check it.

7 **REVIEW**

Who is allowed to tell you when you are not holding it?

## Lead your people

Who carries what — The map of accountability, finished

1 **NAME IT**

List every area of the business and the person accountable for each.

2 **EVIDENCE**

Count how many carry your name.

3 **GAP**

Which of those has a credible successor on the bench you built in level two?

4 **COST**

What is the risk cost of the areas with no successor?

5 DECISION

Decide the one area that gets a named successor this quarter.

6 MOVE

Write who, what they get, and the date.

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 6

### The map of accountability

Everything the business depends on, and who carries it. Then the honest column: what happens if that person is away for a month.

| AREA | CARRIES IT | IF THEY ARE AWAY A MONTH |
|---|---|---|
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |

AREAS WITH AN HONEST ANSWER

What this decides. The single most exposed area, and what you do about it first.

7 REVIEW

What will they have done by the end of the quarter that proves it?

## Lead your business

What runs without you — Tested, not assumed

1 NAME IT

List what now runs without you that did not twelve levels ago.

2

**EVIDENCE**

For each, find the evidence: a week you were away, a decision made elsewhere, a system that held.

3

**GAP**

What is still untested?

4

**COST**

What would a two-week absence cost today? Compare it honestly with twelve levels ago.

5

**DECISION**

Decide the test: a real absence, and its length.

6

**MOVE**

Write the dates, who holds what, and what they are allowed to decide.

7 REVIEW

What will you review on your return, and with whom?

WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 7

### What runs without you

Not assumed — tested. Of the areas on the map above, how many ran for two weeks without you being asked anything.

AREAS THAT RAN WITHOUT YOU

AREAS IN TOTAL

THE BUSINESS THAT RUNS WITHOUT YOU

**The only test that counts.** Documentation, delegation and org charts all describe an intention. Absence measures it. Two weeks is long enough for the ordinary exceptions to arrive and short enough to be survivable — and the result is the only figure in this programme that cannot be improved by trying harder, only by having built something.

What this decides. Which area you test next, and on which dates.

## Lead the market

The business, held together — One page, and somebody else reads it back

1 NAME IT

Write what the business is, who it serves, what it promises, and what makes it hard to copy.

2 EVIDENCE

Gather everything built across these levels: the decision limits, the bench, the systems, the numbers, the edge, the purpose. List what exists and where.

3 GAP

What is still only in your head?

4 **COST**

What is this business worth to someone else right now, and what would raise it most?

5 **DECISION**

Decide the one remaining piece to put on paper.

6 **MOVE**

Write it, assemble the whole onto one page, and say where it lives.

7 **REVIEW**

Who reads it back to you, and what did they ask that shows it is not yet clear?

**WORKSHEET · AFTER CLARITY POINT 7**

## Somebody else reads it back

The business on one page. Then hand it to someone who joined this year and have them read it back to you.

We are _____. We serve _____. They choose us because _____. We can hold that at _____. The person who read this back was _____.

**WHAT THE BUSINESS IS** _____

**WHO IT SERVES** _____

**WHY THEY CHOOSE YOU** _____

**AT WHAT SCALE** _____

**WHO READ IT BACK** _____

**THE BUSINESS, IN ONE PAGE** _____

What this decides. What you rewrite, based on what they could not repeat.

This level closes when all twenty-eight are answered. Not before.